

#1 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What three reading skills does every OSSLT reading question test?

Answer

Every OSSLT reading question tests understanding of explicit information, understanding of implicit information (making inferences), and making connections between the passage and outside knowledge or experience.

#2 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What does it mean when OSSLT theory calls a detail 'explicit'?

Answer

Explicit means the answer is written directly in the passage in plain words. You do not need to guess or read between the lines, you just need to locate it accurately.

#3 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the main trap in explicit understanding questions?

Answer

The information itself is not hidden, but the passage often contains several similar dates, names, or numbers close together, so the trap is finding the exact right detail rather than a similar-looking one.

#4 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What does it mean when a passage tests 'implicit' understanding?

Answer

Implicit means the passage does not state something directly, but gives enough clues for the reader to figure it out. This is called making an inference.

#5 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is an inference, and where must its evidence come from?

Answer

An inference is a conclusion reached using evidence from the text combined with logical reasoning. Every piece of evidence must come from the passage itself, never from outside opinions or assumptions.

#6 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a local inference?

Answer

A local inference is based on one specific sentence or paragraph, such as inferring a character is upset because she slammed a door, even though the word 'upset' never appears.

#7 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a global inference?

Answer

A global inference is based on the passage as a whole, most commonly used for theme questions, where the conclusion is built from a pattern across the entire passage rather than one moment.

#8 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the most important rule for answering any inference question?

Answer

Your answer must be provable using only what is written in the passage. If you catch yourself thinking about what something usually means in real life, stop, because that is not textual evidence.

#9 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the third OSSLT reading skill, making connections?

Answer

Making connections means taking an idea from the passage and connecting it to something broader, such as a general lesson or real-world application, while still keeping the connection clearly supported by the passage.

#10 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How is a connection question different from an inference question?

Answer

An inference question asks you to figure out something the passage strongly implies but does not say outright, staying tightly focused on the text. A connection question asks you to stretch a specific detail into a broader general principle.

#11 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How do the three OSSLT reading skills relate to each other, using the pyramid idea?

Answer

Explicit understanding is the base, made of concrete stated facts. Inference sits in the middle, built on those facts through local and global reasoning. Making connections sits at the top, stretching the passage's ideas outward.

#12 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a single selection question on the OSSLT?

Answer

A single selection question gives a question and a list of choices, usually four, and asks you to pick the one best answer.

#13 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a multiple selection question, and what is the key rule for answering it?

Answer

A multiple selection question asks you to choose more than one correct answer from a list. You must select exactly the number the question specifies, since selecting too few or too many costs marks even if some choices are correct.

#14 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a drag and drop question on the OSSLT?

Answer

A drag and drop question asks you to move items, such as sentences or events, into a specific order or matching category, often putting narrative events into the order they actually happened.

#15 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a drop down menu question?

Answer

A drop down menu question embeds a small menu inside a sentence, and you choose the correct word or phrase from a list to complete the sentence correctly based on the passage.

#16 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a checklist question on the OSSLT?

Answer

A checklist question has you confirm which of several statements are true or false based on the passage, so each item should be checked individually against the text rather than trusted from memory.

#17 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why should you skim a passage before reading it closely?

Answer

Skimming the title, first sentence of each paragraph, and any headings for about thirty seconds gives a rough map of the passage before you commit to reading every word carefully.

#18 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a keyword trap in OSSLT wrong answer choices?

Answer

A keyword trap is built by taking a real detail from the passage and changing one small thing, like a number, name, or direction, so it looks correct at a glance but is not accurate.

#19 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What strategy helps most with single and multiple selection questions?

Answer

Eliminate before you select: cross out any choice that is clearly wrong first, which improves your odds and often makes the correct answer more obvious.

#20 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How should you manage your time across an OSSLT reading section?

Answer

Manage your time by section, not by question. Check your pace after each passage instead of timing individual questions, and move on and return later if one question takes too long.

#21 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Should you ever leave an OSSLT question blank?

Answer

No. There is no penalty for guessing wrong, so an educated guess using elimination always gives a better chance than leaving a question empty.

#22 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a real-life narrative passage?

Answer

A real-life narrative is a passage that tells a story about something that feels real, usually written in first person about an ordinary experience such as starting a job or overcoming a fear.

#23 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What point of view is most common in OSSLT real-life narrative passages?

Answer

First person is far more common, using words like 'I,' 'me,' and 'my,' though some narratives are written in third person following one main character closely.

#24 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Name the five defining features of a real-life narrative passage.

Answer

The five features are personal voice and tone, chronological or reflective structure, sensory and emotional detail, a turning point, and a lesson learned or insight gained.

#25 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is meant by 'personal voice and tone' in a real-life narrative?

Answer

The narrator shares their own thoughts and feelings directly, often using phrases like 'I felt nervous,' giving the passage an honest, personal tone.

#26 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What does 'chronological or reflective structure' mean in a narrative passage?

Answer

Most narratives move through events in the order they happened, and many end with a moment of reflection where the narrator looks back and explains what the experience meant to them.

#27 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why does a real-life narrative include sensory and emotional detail?

Answer

Descriptive detail such as a smell, a sound, or a physical feeling is not just decoration. It helps the reader understand the narrator's emotional state at that moment.

#28 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why is finding the turning point useful when reading a narrative?

Answer

Almost every real-life narrative includes a moment where something shifts, such as a decision or realization, and this moment is one of the most heavily tested parts of the passage.

#29 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is usually the central idea of a real-life narrative passage?

Answer

The lesson learned or insight the narrator gains by the end, since the narrator usually understands something at the end that they did not understand at the beginning.

#30 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What strategy helps you follow events in a narrative passage?

Answer

Track the sequence of events by lightly noting time-signal words like 'at first,' 'later that day,' or 'by the end of the summer,' which act as signposts marking the story's shape.

#31 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why should you notice shifts in a narrator's feelings while reading?

Answer

Feelings often change more than once during a narrative and usually line up with the turning point, so tracking emotional shifts often leads straight to the main idea.

#32 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How can you find the lesson in a narrative if it is never stated directly?

Answer

Look at what the narrator does differently at the end compared to the beginning. That change in behaviour often reveals the lesson even without a direct statement.

#33 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is figurative language, and what are its two common types?

Answer

Figurative language means words not meant to be taken literally. A simile compares two things using 'like' or 'as,' while a metaphor compares two things without using 'like' or 'as.'

#34 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Give an example of a simile and explain what it usually reveals in a narrative.

Answer

'My legs felt like jelly' is a simile. In OSSLT narratives, figurative language almost always shows how the narrator feels inside rather than describing something visually.

#35 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What are the five stages of a typical real-life narrative arc?

Answer

The five stages are the situation, the rising action, the turning point, the resolution, and the reflection.

#36 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What happens during the 'situation' stage of a narrative arc?

Answer

The narrator sets up the circumstances of the story, such as where they are and what is about to happen.

#37 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What happens during the 'rising action' stage of a narrative arc?

Answer

Something starts to go differently than expected, building tension or excitement as the story moves toward its turning point.

#38 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What happens during the 'resolution' stage of a narrative arc?

Answer

The resolution is where the reader learns how the events of the turning point turned out.

#39 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What happens during the 'reflection' stage of a narrative arc?

Answer

The narrator explains, directly or indirectly, what they learned from the whole experience, often revealing the passage's theme.

#40 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is Trap 1 in real-life narrative questions?

Answer

Trap 1 is confusing what the narrator felt with what they said or did, since a narrator can act calm on the outside while feeling something different inside.

#41 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is Trap 2 in real-life narrative questions?

Answer

Trap 2 is mistaking a supporting detail for the main idea. Small details build the world of the story but are not the central lesson or theme.

#42 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is Trap 3 in real-life narrative questions?

Answer

Trap 3 is choosing the most emotional-sounding option instead of the most accurate one. Always trace your answer to specific evidence rather than picking what feels dramatic.

#43 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is Trap 4 in real-life narrative questions?

Answer

Trap 4 is ignoring the turning point. Skipping past this moment can cause you to miss key evidence needed for both local and global inference questions.

#44 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is Trap 5 in real-life narrative questions?

Answer

Trap 5 is overthinking simple explicit-detail questions. If a question can be answered by locating one sentence, trust the text instead of talking yourself into a more complicated answer.

#45 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

In the sample passage 'My First Shift,' what detail is explicitly stated about the narrator's uniform?

Answer

The passage states directly that the narrator wore a bright green polo shirt that still had fold lines pressed into it from the package.

#46 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

In 'My First Shift,' what can be inferred about the older customer's attitude toward the narrator's coupon mistake?

Answer

He was understanding and tried to reassure the narrator, shown through his words 'Take your time' and 'I remember my first job. Everybody was patient with me too.'

#47 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

In 'My First Shift,' what is the central lesson the narrator learns by the end of the passage?

Answer

Being new at something does not mean being bad at it, and mistakes do not mean failure.

#48 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

In 'My First Shift,' what does the simile 'my mind felt like a blank page' suggest?

Answer

It suggests the narrator's memory of the training suddenly felt completely empty, reinforcing that all the training information seemed to vanish in a stressful moment.

#49 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a 'connection' question typically asking in a real-life narrative passage?

Answer

It asks you to link the passage's emotional experience or idea to a similar real-life experience a reader might have had, focusing on matching the feeling rather than the surface topic.

#50 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why should sensory and emotional detail never be mistaken for the main point of a narrative?

Answer

These details make the story feel realistic and help show emotion, but the main idea is usually the broader lesson revealed through the whole arc, not one descriptive detail.

#51 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What kind of topics does a real-life narrative on the OSSLT usually cover?

Answer

Ordinary experiences grounded in real life, such as starting a new job, moving to a new city, trying out for a team, learning to drive, or overcoming a fear.

#52 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How does the narrator's tone usually feel in a real-life narrative?

Answer

Honest and personal, almost as though the narrator is talking directly to a friend, because the narrator shares their own thoughts and feelings openly.

#53 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why is reading the questions before the passage sometimes a useful strategy?

Answer

It tells you what to look for as you read, so you do not have to reread the whole passage later, though this personal strategy will not suit every student equally.

#54 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What should you do if one narrative question is taking much longer than the others?

Answer

Mark your best guess, move on, and come back to it later if time remains at the end, rather than losing time you need for the rest of the section.

#55 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

According to Chapter 1, how does a news report use the same three reading skills as other passages?

Answer

A news report might test connections by asking what a specific local event suggests about a wider issue, even though its surface style looks different from a narrative.

#56 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

According to Chapter 1, how might a dialogue passage test local inference?

Answer

A dialogue passage might test local inference by asking what a character's tone of voice suggests about how they feel, even though the feeling is never stated outright.

#57 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What three questions should you keep asking yourself while reading any OSSLT passage?

Answer

What does the passage state directly? What can I reasonably infer, locally or globally, using only evidence from the text? What broader connection can I draw from this idea?

#58 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why are the four OSSLT passage types considered to test the same underlying skills?

Answer

A real-life narrative, an information paragraph, a news report, and a dialogue all use explicit understanding, inference, and connection questions underneath their different surface styles.

#59 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What should you compare an answer choice against before selecting it on an explicit detail question?

Answer

Compare the answer choice word for word against the exact sentence in the passage rather than trusting your memory of what you read.

#60 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why do narrative passages sometimes include small, unimportant details like a character's backpack colour?

Answer

These details make the story feel realistic, but you should notice they exist without confusing them with the passage's main point.

#61 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the danger of choosing an answer because it 'sounds right in real life' on an inference question?

Answer

OSSLT inferences must be provable using only the text. An answer based on general real-world assumptions rather than passage evidence is not a valid inference.

#62 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

In the sample passage 'My First Shift,' what event marks the story's turning point?

Answer

The moment the narrator struggles to process the older customer's coupons and panics, until the customer's calm reassurance and the manager's help resolve the situation.

#63 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the difference between a fact stated by a narrator and a feeling shown through action?

Answer

A stated fact is written directly in the text, while a feeling shown through action, like slamming a door, must be inferred from behaviour rather than read as a direct statement.

#64 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why does EQAO use several different interface formats for reading questions instead of just one?

Answer

The different formats are not designed to trick you through technology. They are simply different containers for showing the same three underlying reading skills.

#65 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What should you do first when a new drag and drop reordering question appears?

Answer

Read the whole passage first before attempting to reorder anything, since dragging based on a half-formed memory of the passage often leads to mistakes.

#66 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why is it risky to trust your memory instead of rereading the passage on checklist questions?

Answer

Checklist items should be confirmed individually against the passage, since trusting memory over the actual text increases the chance of marking an item incorrectly.

#67 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the danger of overstating an answer choice into an absolute claim, such as saying something is 'the only way'?

Answer

An answer that turns a passage's specific evidence into an absolute claim overstates what the text actually supports and is usually incorrect on connection questions.

#68 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why might a real-life narrative jump back in time briefly instead of staying perfectly chronological?

Answer

Some narratives include the narrator remembering something from the past in the middle of the story, though the overall shape still usually moves forward in time.

#69 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the purpose of the concluding reflection often found at the end of a real-life narrative?

Answer

The narrator looks back and explains, directly or indirectly, what the experience meant to them, which usually reveals the passage's central theme or lesson.

#70 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How can you tell the difference between a narrator's internal feeling and an external action in a narrative passage?

Answer

Check whether the question is asking about the narrator's emotions, their words, or their behaviour, since these are not always the same thing in a narrative.

#71 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why is 'proud' a reasonable inference for the teenagers in the skate park passage even though the word never appears?

Answer

The passage gives strong supporting evidence, including two years of fundraising, a public ribbon cutting, and a quote about creating real change, all pointing toward pride.

#72 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

In the skate park passage, why is answer C wrong for a connection question that overstates fundraising as 'the only way' to build public spaces?

Answer

It overstates the passage's point into an absolute claim, since the passage never claims fundraising is the only method that works for building public spaces.

#73 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the purpose of a worked example showing both an explicit and an inference question on the same passage?

Answer

It shows how the same passage can be tested at different depths, from locating a stated fact to reasoning through evidence that is only implied.

#74 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why should you slow down when you sense a narrative shifting in tone or direction?

Answer

Slowing down at a shift helps you notice the turning point, which usually holds key evidence for inference questions about the narrator's feelings or the passage's theme.

#75 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the risk of picking the most dramatic-sounding answer on a narrative theme question?

Answer

Test makers sometimes include an answer that sounds exciting but is not supported by the passage, so accuracy should always outweigh emotional appeal.

#76 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why does the OSSLT test both local and global inference rather than only one type?

Answer

Local inference checks careful reading of a single moment, while global inference checks whether you can recognize a pattern or theme built across an entire passage.

#77 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is a common feature of the closing paragraph in a real-life narrative?

Answer

The closing paragraph usually contains the reflection stage, where the narrator states or implies the lesson learned from the whole experience.

#78 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

How does a real-life narrative differ from an information paragraph in tone?

Answer

A real-life narrative has a personal, emotional voice, while an information paragraph stays neutral and factual without sharing personal feelings.

#79 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why is it useful to notice when a narrator's feelings change more than once in a passage?

Answer

Multiple emotional shifts often map onto the story's arc, helping you locate the turning point and the eventual lesson learned.

#80 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What should you do if you cannot find a sentence stating the narrator's lesson directly?

Answer

Look at how the narrator's actions or attitude differ between the beginning and the end of the passage, since that change often reveals the lesson.

#81 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why is 'Anaya says the park proves young people can create real change' considered evidence for a connection question rather than an inference question?

Answer

It is used to support a broader general truth about community projects, which is the kind of wider stretch that a connection question asks for rather than a narrower inference.

#82 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the safest approach when a real-life narrative question and a connection question both seem to fit an answer choice?

Answer

Check whether the choice stays tightly tied to the passage's specific evidence (inference) or stretches the idea into a wider general principle (connection), and match the choice to what the question is actually asking.

#83 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the difference between a topic and a theme in a real-life narrative?

Answer

A topic is the general subject the story is about, such as a first job, while the theme is the deeper lesson or insight the narrator draws from that experience.

#84 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

Why should you avoid bringing personal opinions into an OSSLT inference answer?

Answer

An inference must be supported entirely by evidence in the passage. Personal opinions or outside assumptions are not valid support, even if they feel reasonable.

#85 · Real-Life Narrative Reading

What is the benefit of predicting what a real-life narrative will be about before reading it closely?

Answer

A quick skim of the opening gives you a rough map of the story's setting and situation, which makes close reading faster and helps you notice the turning point when it arrives.

#86 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is an information paragraph on the OSSLT?

Answer

An information paragraph is a short factual text that explains something, such as how a machine works or an overview of a topic, with the sole goal of teaching the reader facts clearly.

#87 · Information Paragraph Reading

How is an information paragraph different from a news report?

Answer

An information paragraph explains general facts about a topic rather than telling about a specific event that happened on a specific day, which is what a news report does.

#88 · Information Paragraph Reading

How is an information paragraph different from a persuasive or opinion piece?

Answer

An information paragraph does not try to persuade the reader of anything. It stays neutral and factual, while a persuasive piece tries to convince the reader to believe or do something.

#89 · Information Paragraph Reading

What tone does an information paragraph usually have?

Answer

A neutral tone. The writer sounds like a teacher or reference book sharing accurate facts in a steady, even voice, without trying to make the reader feel excited or worried.

#90 · Information Paragraph Reading

What phrases signal that a passage might be persuasive rather than a neutral information paragraph?

Answer

Phrases like 'you should,' 'everyone must,' or 'this is the best way' signal a persuasive or opinion-based text rather than a neutral information paragraph.

#91 · Information Paragraph Reading

What two parts make up the basic structure of an information paragraph?

Answer

A topic sentence, which states the main idea, and a series of supporting details, which are facts, examples, numbers, or explanations that back up that main idea.

#92 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the role of a topic sentence in an information paragraph?

Answer

The topic sentence is the 'big picture' statement that tells the reader the main idea of the whole paragraph or passage.

#93 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the role of supporting details in an information paragraph?

Answer

Supporting details are the 'zoomed in' evidence, such as specific facts or examples, that back up and expand on the topic sentence.

#94 · Information Paragraph Reading

Is the topic sentence always the very first sentence of an information paragraph?

Answer

Not always. A writer sometimes opens with a hook, such as an interesting fact or short question, and states the main idea in the second or third sentence.

#95 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is sequence structure in an information paragraph?

Answer

Sequence structure explains steps in order, usually using words like first, next, then, after that, and finally, common when explaining a process.

#96 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is cause and effect structure in an information paragraph?

Answer

Cause and effect structure explains why something happens and what results from it, using words like because, as a result, therefore, and due to.

#97 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is compare and contrast structure in an information paragraph?

Answer

Compare and contrast structure looks at two or more things and shows similarities or differences, using words like similarly, in contrast, however, both, and unlike.

#98 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is description structure in an information paragraph?

Answer

Description structure lays out facts and details about a single topic without a strong step-by-step or cause-and-effect focus, often moving from general to specific information.

#99 · Information Paragraph Reading

Can an information paragraph blend more than one organizational pattern?

Answer

Yes. A passage might use sequence to explain stages of a process and cause and effect to explain why something happens within that process, so signal words matter more than a single label.

#100 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is step one of the strategic approach to reading an information paragraph?

Answer

Read the title or heading if there is one, then read the first one or two sentences carefully to identify the topic and main idea.

#101 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is step two of the strategic approach to reading an information paragraph?

Answer

Notice structure signal words as you read, such as first, next, because, as a result, similarly, and unlike, since these words show what kind of information is coming.

#102 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is step three of the strategic approach to reading an information paragraph?

Answer

Separate facts from examples: a fact is a general statement, while an example is a specific instance used to support that fact.

#103 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is step four of the strategic approach to reading an information paragraph?

Answer

After each paragraph, ask yourself 'what is the one main thing I just learned?' If your answer is a small detail rather than a broad statement, look again for the topic sentence.

#104 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is step five of the strategic approach to reading an information paragraph?

Answer

Always go back to the passage to check your answer rather than relying only on memory, since the correct answer will be directly supported by the text.

#105 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the difference between a fact and an example in an information paragraph?

Answer

A fact is a general statement of information, while an example is a specific instance used to illustrate that general fact.

#106 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is confusing a fact with an example a common trap on main idea questions?

Answer

A question may offer an example from inside the paragraph as an answer choice, and while it might be true, it is too narrow to be the main idea, which must cover the whole paragraph.

#107 · Information Paragraph Reading

How can you test whether an answer choice is really the main idea or just a supporting detail?

Answer

Ask whether the answer choice explains everything in the paragraph or only part of it. An answer that only accounts for one sentence is likely a disguised supporting detail.

#108 · Information Paragraph Reading

In the insulated water bottle passage, what design feature keeps drinks cold?

Answer

A vacuum-sealed double wall, where almost all the air is removed from the gap between two layers of metal, creating a near vacuum that heat struggles to cross.

#109 · Information Paragraph Reading

What organizational pattern explains how the vacuum layer in the water bottle passage blocks heat?

Answer

Cause and effect, since removing air is the cause and blocking heat transfer is the effect that follows from it.

#110 · Information Paragraph Reading

According to the water bottle passage, what are the three ways heat can move?

Answer

Conduction, convection, and radiation.

#111 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is conduction, according to the water bottle passage?

Answer

Conduction happens when heat passes directly through a solid material, like a spoon left in hot soup.

#112 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is convection, according to the water bottle passage?

Answer

Convection happens when heat moves through a moving liquid or gas, such as warm air rising in a room.

#113 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is radiation, according to the water bottle passage?

Answer

Radiation happens when heat travels as invisible waves, similar to how the sun warms your skin from a distance.

#114 · Information Paragraph Reading

According to the water bottle passage, what would happen if the weld at the top of the bottle cracked?

Answer

Outside air could leak into the vacuum gap, and the passage states this would cause the insulation to stop working properly.

#115 · Information Paragraph Reading

According to the water bottle passage, how does mentioning single-wall bottles connect to the main idea?

Answer

It provides a comparison that helps show why the vacuum design is effective, since single-wall bottles warm up or cool down within just an hour or two.

#116 · Information Paragraph Reading

According to the water bottle passage, how long can a well-made insulated bottle keep hot tea warm?

Answer

12 hours or longer, according to the passage.

#117 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the biggest trap in information paragraph questions asking for a summary or main purpose?

Answer

Mistaking a supporting example for the main idea. The correct answer must be broad enough to cover the whole paragraph, not just one detail.

#118 · Information Paragraph Reading

What trap involves a detail that is technically true but does not answer the question being asked?

Answer

A passage may include several true facts, but if the question asks specifically about cause and effect or a specific number, your answer must match exactly what is being asked, not any true statement you remember.

#119 · Information Paragraph Reading

What trap involves mixing up two similar numbers that appear close together in a passage?

Answer

Test writers sometimes attach a correct number from the passage to the wrong detail, so you must match each number to its correct detail by rereading the exact sentence.

#120 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why might a passage that compares benefits still count as an information paragraph rather than a persuasive one?

Answer

Comparing benefits neutrally, presenting facts about both sides without telling the reader what to believe or do, keeps a passage in the information paragraph category.

#121 · Information Paragraph Reading

Do information paragraph questions usually require outside knowledge?

Answer

No. Information paragraph questions are almost always answerable directly from the text, so relying on prior knowledge instead of the passage is a sign you should reread.

#122 · Information Paragraph Reading

What signal words point to a sequence structure passage?

Answer

Words like first, next, then, after that, and finally, which show steps happening in order.

#123 · Information Paragraph Reading

What signal words point to a cause and effect structure passage?

Answer

Words like because, as a result, therefore, due to, and this leads to.

#124 · Information Paragraph Reading

What signal words point to a compare and contrast structure passage?

Answer

Words like similarly, in contrast, however, both, and unlike.

#125 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why does an information paragraph avoid emotional language?

Answer

Its only job is to inform calmly and clearly, so the writer avoids language designed to make the reader feel excited, worried, or angry.

#126 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of question asks you to identify whether a passage uses sequence, cause and effect, compare and contrast, or description?

Answer

A text structure question, which tests whether you can recognize the organizational pattern a passage or section of a passage is using.

#127 · Information Paragraph Reading

According to the water bottle passage, what happens to the air in the gap before the bottle is sealed?

Answer

Almost all of the air is removed, creating a near vacuum, an explicit detail stated directly in the passage.

#128 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the purpose of a reflective coating that some insulated bottles add inside the vacuum layer?

Answer

It bounces radiant heat back toward its source, further slowing the transfer of heat in addition to the vacuum gap itself.

#129 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is it important to reread the exact sentence in the passage before answering an information paragraph question?

Answer

Wrong answer choices are often built from real details with one small change, so comparing the choice word for word against the passage avoids being misled by a close but incorrect number or detail.

#130 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of paragraph structure would most likely explain how a volcano forms?

Answer

A blend of sequence, to explain the stages of formation, and cause and effect, to explain why pressure builds up underground.

#131 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why should you not assign a single perfect structure label to every information paragraph?

Answer

Many real passages blend more than one organizational pattern, so noticing the signal words is more useful than forcing one exact label onto the whole passage.

#132 · Information Paragraph Reading

What does it mean to separate a 'fact' from an 'example' while reading an information paragraph?

Answer

A fact is the general statement being taught, while an example is a specific case used to illustrate it, and OSSLT questions often test the difference between the two.

#133 · Information Paragraph Reading

How should you check your answer after reading an information paragraph and its questions?

Answer

Go back to the exact part of the text that supports your answer choice rather than trusting your memory of the passage.

#134 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is a 'hook' at the start of an information paragraph?

Answer

An interesting fact or short question used to open the paragraph before the main idea is stated in a later sentence, rather than the very first line.

#135 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is the phrase 'this is the best way' a clue that a passage might not be a neutral information paragraph?

Answer

It expresses a judgment or recommendation rather than a neutral fact, which is a signal of persuasive writing rather than an information paragraph's steady, even voice.

#136 · Information Paragraph Reading

What should you ask yourself after reading each paragraph of an information passage to find the main idea?

Answer

Ask 'what is the one main thing I just learned?' If your answer is broad, you likely found the main idea; if it is a small detail, look again for the topic sentence.

#137 · Information Paragraph Reading

In the water bottle passage, why is it wrong to describe the passage as using a narrative structure?

Answer

There is no story about a specific student and no personal narrative anywhere in the passage. It stays factual and explanatory throughout.

#138 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the danger of choosing an answer that is 'true' but does not match the specific type of question being asked?

Answer

A true statement that does not address the specific focus of the question, such as cause and effect or a sequence, is still an incorrect answer even though it is factually accurate.

#139 · Information Paragraph Reading

How many main ways can heat move, according to the water bottle passage, and what blocks all of them at once?

Answer

Heat can move through conduction, convection, and radiation, and the vacuum layer in an insulated bottle is designed to block all three at once.

#140 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of detail usually appears at the very end of an information paragraph that follows an inverted structure of general-to-specific?

Answer

The most specific supporting details or a closing statement connecting the facts back to a bigger everyday idea, such as remembering the science behind a cold drink at lunch.

#141 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is neutrality one of the clearest signals of an information paragraph?

Answer

Because the writer is not giving a personal opinion or trying to persuade, but simply reporting accurate facts in a steady, even voice like a reference book.

#142 · Information Paragraph Reading

What should you do if you find yourself relying on something you already knew before reading an information paragraph rather than something stated in the text?

Answer

Stop and reread the relevant section, since the correct answer should come from the passage itself, not from outside knowledge you already had.

#143 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the correct answer type for a question that asks 'according to the passage, how much did X cost' or 'how many Y took part'?

Answer

An explicit detail question, since the exact number or amount is stated directly somewhere in the passage.

#144 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why do OSSLT information paragraph passages often include multiple similar numbers or dates?

Answer

To test whether you can carefully match the exact number to its correct detail, rather than confusing two similar figures that appear close together in the text.

#145 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the relationship between a topic sentence and the supporting details that follow it?

Answer

The supporting details each provide evidence, examples, or explanation that backs up and expands upon the claim made in the topic sentence.

#146 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why might an information paragraph on the OSSLT include several distinct organizational signal words in one passage?

Answer

Because real passages often blend patterns such as sequence and cause and effect, and each signal word tells you what kind of information or relationship is coming next.

#147 · Information Paragraph Reading

How does an information paragraph typically end?

Answer

It often closes with a statement that ties the facts together or connects them back to something relatable, without offering a personal opinion or persuasive call to action.

#148 · Information Paragraph Reading

What makes description structure different from sequence structure?

Answer

Description structure lays out facts about a single topic without a strong step-by-step order, while sequence structure explicitly follows a process through ordered steps.

#149 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why would a passage explaining 'how bread rises' most likely use a sequence structure?

Answer

Because it explains a process that unfolds through ordered steps over time, which matches the definition of sequence structure using words like first, next, and finally.

#150 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why would a passage explaining 'why ice floats on water' most likely use a cause and effect structure?

Answer

Because it explains the reason something happens, matching the definition of cause and effect structure using words like because and as a result.

#151 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why would a passage comparing two energy sources most likely use a compare and contrast structure?

Answer

Because it examines two things and shows their similarities or differences, matching the definition of compare and contrast structure using words like similarly and in contrast.

#152 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is one clear sign that a paragraph is persuasive rather than a neutral information paragraph?

Answer

The writer tells the reader what to believe or do, using language like 'you should' or 'everyone must,' rather than presenting facts in a steady, neutral voice.

#153 · Information Paragraph Reading

According to the water bottle passage, what happens to drinks in a cheap single-wall bottle?

Answer

They warm up or cool down to match the surrounding temperature much faster, often within just an hour or two, since there is no vacuum gap.

#154 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the purpose of the outer and inner walls being welded together near the opening of an insulated bottle?

Answer

The weld forms a single sealed unit, and this seal is important because if outside air leaks into the vacuum gap, the insulation stops working properly.

#155 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is 'B' the correct answer when a passage states a fact using the exact wording of an answer choice?

Answer

Because explicit detail questions are answered by matching the passage's own words directly, so an answer choice using the same wording as the text is very likely correct.

#156 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of reading question checks whether you understand HOW a paragraph is organized, rather than WHAT it says?

Answer

A text structure question, which asks you to identify a pattern such as sequence, cause and effect, compare and contrast, or description.

#157 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is 'the writer's tone stays even throughout' a useful clue when identifying an information paragraph?

Answer

A steady, even tone without emotional language throughout the passage supports the conclusion that it is a neutral information paragraph rather than a persuasive piece.

#158 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of paragraph would explain 'the parts of a place or object' without a strong step-by-step order?

Answer

A description-structure paragraph, which lays out facts and details about a single topic, often moving from general to specific information.

#159 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why should you avoid choosing an answer for a summary question if it only restates one sentence from the middle of the passage?

Answer

A true summary or main idea answer needs to represent the whole paragraph, while an answer built from only one sentence is too narrow and is likely a supporting detail in disguise.

#160 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of evidence supports an explicit detail answer versus an inference answer in an information paragraph?

Answer

An explicit detail answer is supported by a sentence stated directly in the text, while an inference answer is supported by evidence that must be reasoned through, even though it still must come from the passage.

#161 • Information Paragraph Reading

Why does EQAO test the ability to distinguish a general fact from a specific example?

Answer

Because confusing an example for the main idea is one of the most common ways students choose an incorrect answer on main idea and summary questions.

#162 • Information Paragraph Reading

What should you notice about a passage's opening two or three sentences before deciding you have found the topic sentence?

Answer

Read the whole opening carefully, since a writer sometimes opens with an interesting hook before stating the actual main idea a sentence or two later.

#163 · Information Paragraph Reading

How does an information paragraph typically avoid sounding one-sided even when discussing advantages of something?

Answer

It presents facts about both sides in a neutral way without instructing the reader on what to believe or do, keeping the passage informative rather than persuasive.

#164 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the safest strategy when two answer choices to an information paragraph question both contain true information from the passage?

Answer

Check which choice actually matches what the specific question is asking, since a true but off-target detail is still an incorrect answer.

#165 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is 'the vacuum gap blocks conduction, convection, and radiation' a strong summary sentence for part of the water bottle passage?

Answer

It captures the broad main point of that section rather than describing just one of the three heat-transfer methods individually.

#166 · Information Paragraph Reading

What should you do before answering an information paragraph question if you are unsure whether an answer choice is a fact or a persuasive opinion?

Answer

Check whether the language expresses a personal judgment or recommendation versus a neutral, checkable statement, since only the neutral statement fits an information paragraph's tone.

#167 · Information Paragraph Reading

What is the risk of assuming the very first sentence of a paragraph is always the topic sentence?

Answer

Occasionally a writer opens with a hook before stating the main idea, so reading the whole opening carefully avoids missing the real topic sentence.

#168 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is 'the writer sounds like a teacher or reference book' a helpful way to remember an information paragraph's tone?

Answer

It captures the calm, neutral, fact-focused voice that separates an information paragraph from a persuasive or narrative passage.

#169 · Information Paragraph Reading

What kind of passage would explain the features of a hobby or an animal without describing a specific event?

Answer

An information paragraph, since its goal is to teach general facts about a topic rather than report on something that happened on a specific day.

#170 · Information Paragraph Reading

Why is checking the exact sentence in the passage more reliable than trusting memory for a numbers-based question?

Answer

Because information paragraphs often place similar numbers close together on purpose, and only the exact sentence confirms which number matches which detail.

#171 • News Report Reading

What is a news report on the OSSLT?

Answer

A news report is a piece of writing that tells about something that happened, almost always something recent, written the way a newspaper or news website would write it.

#172 • News Report Reading

Why does the news report passage matter so much on the OSSLT?

Answer

One of the five reading passages on every OSSLT sitting is always a news report, and it always comes with a short written open-response question, not just multiple choice.

#173 · News Report Reading

What is the headline of a news report?

Answer

The headline is the short title at the top of the passage meant to grab attention and give a quick idea of what the whole passage is about.

#174 · News Report Reading

What are the byline and dateline of a news report?

Answer

The byline tells you who wrote the article, and the dateline tells you where and when the story is happening, usually appearing near the headline or start of the article.

#175 · News Report Reading

What is the lead paragraph of a news report?

Answer

The lead is the first paragraph of a news report, and it is the most important paragraph because it tries to answer the main questions a reader would have about the story.

#176 · News Report Reading

What are the Five W's plus How?

Answer

Who, what, when, where, why, and how, the six basic questions a well-written news report tries to answer as early as possible, usually in the lead paragraph.

#177 · News Report Reading

Why is the lead paragraph especially useful for answering OSSLT explicit detail questions?

Answer

A well-written news report answers as many of the Five W's plus How as possible in the very first paragraph, so basic facts are very often found there.

#178 · News Report Reading

What is the inverted pyramid structure?

Answer

A news writing structure where the most important information comes first, in the headline and lead, with supporting details in the middle and the smallest, least essential details near the end.

#179 · News Report Reading

How is the inverted pyramid structure different from how a short story is usually built?

Answer

A short story often saves the most important information for the end, while a news report puts the most important facts first and the least essential details last.

#180 · News Report Reading

Why does the inverted pyramid help you read a news report strategically?

Answer

The biggest, most test-worthy facts are almost always near the top of the passage, so you can predict where key information is likely to be located.

#181 · News Report Reading

What tone does a news report use?

Answer

An objective, third-person tone meant to sound fair and neutral, since the writer is not supposed to insert their own opinion directly into the reporting.

#182 · News Report Reading

How does a news report show opinions or feelings without the writer stating them as fact?

Answer

Through direct quotes from named sources, letting the story include personal opinions and reactions without the reporter stating those opinions as objective fact.

#183 · News Report Reading

What is a 'source' in a news report?

Answer

A source is a person quoted in the story, such as an organizer, someone affected by the event, an expert, or an official like a city councillor or principal.

#184 · News Report Reading

What is Step 1 of reading a news report strategically?

Answer

Read the headline and predict what topic, kind of event, and possibly who is involved before reading the body of the passage.

#185 • News Report Reading

What is Step 2 of reading a news report strategically?

Answer

Find the Five W's plus How in the lead paragraph, since many explicit detail questions are answered directly in this first paragraph.

#186 • News Report Reading

What is Step 3 of reading a news report strategically?

Answer

Track who is speaking in each quote and notice what role that person plays in the story, since quotes are a favourite place for OSSLT questions.

#187 · News Report Reading

What is Step 4 of reading a news report strategically?

Answer

Separate reported fact from quoted opinion, checking whether a statement is something the writer states directly or something a person says using personal or emotional language.

#188 · News Report Reading

What is Step 5 of reading a news report strategically?

Answer

Notice how quotes support the main idea by asking what a particular quote adds that a plain fact could not.

#189 · News Report Reading

What is a reported fact in a news report?

Answer

Something the writer states directly, such as a date, number, location, or action that took place, that can be checked or confirmed.

#190 · News Report Reading

What is a quoted opinion in a news report?

Answer

Something a person says using words like 'I think,' 'I feel,' or emotional language such as 'amazing' or 'disappointing,' shown inside quotation marks and attributed to a specific person.

#191 · News Report Reading

In the community garden passage, how many students took part in the project?

Answer

Twenty-two students took part in the project as part of their environmental science credit.

#192 · News Report Reading

In the community garden passage, why did the writer likely include Terrence Wall's quote?

Answer

To show that even a skeptical neighbour changed his mind after seeing the results, since he starts doubtful and ends impressed.

#193 • News Report Reading

In the community garden passage, which statement is a quoted opinion rather than a stated fact?

Answer

Councillor Nath's statement that 'these students saw a problem and solved it themselves' is a quoted opinion, since it reflects her personal judgment about the students.

#194 • News Report Reading

What is the difference between the fact 'the garden opened to the public on Saturday' and the quote 'these students saw a problem and solved it themselves'?

Answer

The first is a stated fact describing an event, while the second is a quoted personal opinion expressing a judgment about the students.

#195 · News Report Reading

What does the OSSLT open-response reading rubric reward, according to the strong sample response for the community garden passage?

Answer

Accurate, specific, and relevant ideas taken directly from the passage, such as named details, numbers, or quotes, rather than vague general statements.

#196 · News Report Reading

Why did the weak sample open response about the community garden score poorly?

Answer

It offered only vague, general statements like 'worked really hard' and 'everyone was happy,' with no specific evidence pulled from the text.

#197 · News Report Reading

What is Trap 1 in news report questions?

Answer

Mixing up the reporter's words with a source's words, choosing an answer that sounds like a fact but is actually only someone's personal opinion inside quotation marks.

#198 · News Report Reading

What is Trap 2 in news report questions?

Answer

Assuming the headline tells the whole story, when the headline is only a summary and some questions test details that go beyond what it suggests.

#199 · News Report Reading

What is Trap 3 in news report questions?

Answer

Picking the most dramatic-sounding quote instead of the most relevant one when answering an inference question about why a quote was included.

#200 · News Report Reading

What is Trap 4 in news report questions?

Answer

Forgetting that later paragraphs hold smaller details, since the inverted pyramid structure means specific facts like exact dates can appear near the end.

#201 · News Report Reading

What is Trap 5 in news report questions?

Answer

Writing a vague open response with no evidence, instead of naming a detail, number, person, or quote to support the answer.

#202 · News Report Reading

What is Trap 6 in news report questions?

Answer

Confusing who said a quote with who the quote is about, especially when two different people express slightly different opinions about the same event.

#203 • News Report Reading

Why is a news report written in third person rather than first person?

Answer

Because the writer is reporting on events and people from an outside, objective point of view rather than sharing their own personal experience.

#204 • News Report Reading

How would a news report rewrite the opinion 'the new playground is wonderful and everyone loves it' to stay objective?

Answer

It would attribute the opinion to a source, such as 'several parents said they were pleased with the new playground,' rather than stating it as the writer's own fact.

#205 • News Report Reading

Why do news reports rely heavily on direct quotations?

Answer

Quotes let the story include personal opinions, feelings, and reactions from real people without the reporter stating those opinions as objective fact.

#206 • News Report Reading

What should you check before selecting an answer that identifies a statement as a 'fact' in a news report question?

Answer

Check whether the sentence is something the writer states directly, or something a named person says inside quotation marks, since the two are treated very differently.

#207 • News Report Reading

Why does the lead paragraph of a news report usually answer the most questions a reader would have?

Answer

Because news writing is built so that even a reader who only reads the first few lines still understands the basic story, thanks to the Five W's plus How being addressed early.

#208 • News Report Reading

What kind of detail is more likely to appear near the end of a news report rather than near the top?

Answer

The smallest, most specific details, extra background information, or less important quotes, due to the inverted pyramid structure.

#209 • News Report Reading

How can you identify who is being quoted and their role in a news report?

Answer

Notice the name attached to the quotation marks and consider what role that person plays in the story, such as organizer, witness, official, or someone affected.

#210 • News Report Reading

Why is Terrence Wall's quote in the community garden passage evidence of a changed opinion rather than ongoing skepticism?

Answer

His quote moves from doubt at the start ('I thought the weeds would take over again by June') to being impressed by the end ('I have to say, I'm impressed with what they built').

#211 • News Report Reading

What kind of language signals a quoted opinion rather than a reported fact?

Answer

Personal judgment language or emotional words such as 'I think,' 'I feel,' 'amazing,' or 'disappointing,' especially when shown inside quotation marks and attributed to a person.

#212 • News Report Reading

What should an open-response answer about a news report always include to score well?

Answer

Specific evidence from the passage, such as a name, number, date, or direct quote, rather than a general impression with no supporting detail.

#213 · News Report Reading

Why might a question about a news report ask you to distinguish 'who said it' from 'who it is about'?

Answer

Because a report can quote several different people, and some questions test whether you can correctly match a quote to the right speaker rather than confusing two speakers.

#214 · News Report Reading

What is the purpose of a dateline in a news report?

Answer

It tells the reader where and when the story is happening, helping establish the setting of the report right away.

#215 • News Report Reading

Why is 'objective' the correct word to describe a news report's intended tone?

Answer

Objective means fair and neutral, showing that the writer is not supposed to insert personal opinion directly into the reporting of events.

#216 • News Report Reading

What common feature of a headline should you notice before reading the body of a news report?

Answer

A good headline often hints at the who and the what of the story, giving you a frame to predict the content before you start reading.

#217 • News Report Reading

Why does the inverted pyramid structure make a news report easier to skim quickly?

Answer

Because the most important, test-worthy information is placed near the top, so a quick read of the headline and lead paragraph often reveals the core facts.

#218 • News Report Reading

In the science fair or community garden style of passage, why would councillor Nath's quote be chosen by the writer?

Answer

It supports the main idea of the story by adding a public official's endorsement of the students' initiative, strengthening the sense that the project was a success.

#219 • News Report Reading

How should you handle a question asking why a specific quote was included in a news report?

Answer

Ask what that quote adds to the story's main idea rather than picking the answer that simply sounds the most emotional or dramatic.

#220 • News Report Reading

What is the danger of assuming a fact stated in the middle of a news report must be less important than one in the lead?

Answer

Middle paragraphs still contain supporting details and explanation directly connected to the main idea, even though the most essential facts usually appear first.

#221 • News Report Reading

Why is Mr. Devries's quote about the garden's goal important to the passage's main idea?

Answer

He states that 'the goal was never just to grow vegetables for one season' but to show students they can make a real difference, tying the specific event to a broader lesson.

#222 • News Report Reading

What should you do if two named sources in a news report express similar but not identical opinions?

Answer

Carefully match each specific detail of the opinion to the correct name, since questions may test whether you can tell the two viewpoints apart accurately.

#223 · News Report Reading

How is a fact like 'the food bank is expected to receive vegetables next week' different from a quoted line like 'these students saw a problem and solved it themselves'?

Answer

The first is a reported fact stating an expected event, while the second is a quoted opinion expressing a personal judgment about the students.

#224 · News Report Reading

What makes a news report passage realistic rather than fictional in style?

Answer

Its topics are ordinary and grounded in real community life, such as a bake sale, road closure, new bike lane, or science fair, rather than fantastical events.

#225 · News Report Reading

Why should you never assume a headline alone is enough to answer a detail question?

Answer

The headline only summarizes the story, so specific facts about challenges, skepticism, or minor details may only appear later in the body of the report.

#226 · News Report Reading

What does it mean for a news report to be 'not one-sided'?

Answer

The writer avoids inserting personal judgment and instead lets sources express opinions through quotes, keeping the overall reporting fair and neutral.

#227 · News Report Reading

What kind of evidence in a strong open response shows a marker that a student truly read and understood a news report passage?

Answer

Specific, named details such as a number, a quoted line, or a person's name that could only come from actually reading and understanding the passage.

#228 · News Report Reading

Why is it a mistake to describe general statements like 'they worked really hard and everyone was happy' as strong evidence in an open response?

Answer

These statements are vague enough to apply to almost any success story and do not demonstrate that the student engaged with the specific facts in the passage.

#229 · News Report Reading

What kind of question asks you to identify the who, what, when, where, why, or how of a news report?

Answer

An explicit detail question, since the Five W's plus How are typically stated directly, often in the lead paragraph.

#230 · News Report Reading

Why might an OSSLT question about a news report ask which sentence is 'stated' versus which is 'implied by a source's tone'?

Answer

Because separating reported fact from quoted opinion is one of the most heavily tested skills in news report passages.

#231 · News Report Reading

What should you notice about the order of paragraphs when a news report explains challenges the project faced?

Answer

Challenges or doubts, such as a skeptical neighbour's early opinion, may appear in a middle paragraph rather than the lead, since the inverted pyramid still allows supporting narrative details after the main facts.

#232 · News Report Reading

Why is the phrase 'said Councillor Nath' important to notice when reading her quote?

Answer

It attributes the opinion to a specific named person, confirming the statement is a quoted opinion rather than a neutral fact stated by the writer.

#233 · News Report Reading

What is the safest way to answer a question asking 'according to the passage' about a news report?

Answer

Locate the exact sentence stating the fact, since news reports are built to answer basic questions directly and explicitly, usually early in the passage.

#234 · News Report Reading

Why does a well-organized news report answer as many of the Five W's plus How as early as possible?

Answer

So that even a reader who only reads the first few lines understands the basic story, which is the defining purpose of the lead paragraph.

#235 · News Report Reading

What role does a 'source' typically play when a news report includes a personal reaction to an event?

Answer

The source provides the emotional or opinionated reaction through a direct quote, keeping the writer's own voice neutral and fact-based.

#236 · News Report Reading

Why would an OSSLT question use two similar quotes from different speakers in the same news report?

Answer

To test whether you can correctly match each opinion to the right speaker rather than confusing the two viewpoints.

#237 • News Report Reading

What kind of information is least likely to appear in the very first paragraph of a news report?

Answer

The smallest, most specific background details or less essential quotes, which the inverted pyramid structure usually places near the end instead.

#238 • News Report Reading

According to the OSSLT open-response guidance, what should you do if you are unsure how to start your written response about a news report?

Answer

Restate the key idea using your own words, then immediately support it with a specific detail, number, or quote directly from the passage.

#239 · News Report Reading

Why is 'a group of Grade 9 students' more useful as an explicit-detail answer than 'some students' in the community garden passage?

Answer

Because the passage explicitly identifies the students as Grade 9, and an explicit detail answer must match the exact information stated in the text.

#240 · News Report Reading

What is the value of noticing whether a speaker's opinion changes between two quotes in the same news report?

Answer

It can reveal a shift, such as skepticism turning into being impressed, which is often the exact point a question about why a quote was chosen is testing.

#241 • News Report Reading

How should you treat an answer choice in a news report question that sounds true but is not stated or quoted anywhere in the passage?

Answer

Reject it, since a news report question must be answered using only what is explicitly stated or quoted in that specific passage, not general assumptions.

#242 • News Report Reading

What is the function of the final paragraph in many news reports, according to the inverted pyramid structure?

Answer

It typically holds smaller, less essential details, such as ongoing plans or minor logistics, rather than the story's most important facts.

#243 · News Report Reading

Why does a councillor's or official's quote often appear in a community-focused news report?

Answer

To add a credible, public voice supporting or commenting on the event, which strengthens the sense of the story's significance to the wider community.

#244 · News Report Reading

What is the key difference between 'the writer's opinion' and 'a source's opinion' in a properly written news report?

Answer

A properly written news report should contain no direct opinion from the writer at all. Any opinion present comes from a quoted source, not from the reporter's own voice.

#245 · News Report Reading

Why should you always check the exact wording of a quote before answering a fact-versus-opinion question?

Answer

Because a quote's precise wording, such as personal judgment language, is what identifies it as an opinion rather than a neutral, checkable fact.

#246 · News Report Reading

How does the sample community garden passage demonstrate a project overcoming doubt?

Answer

It shows a skeptical neighbour who doubted the project at first but became impressed after watching it succeed over the summer, demonstrating a shift supporting the story's success.

#247 • News Report Reading

Why is it useful to notice which paragraph a specific quote appears in when answering a news report question?

Answer

The paragraph's position hints at the quote's importance under the inverted pyramid, and the surrounding sentences often provide context needed to interpret the quote correctly.

#248 • News Report Reading

What is the danger of writing an open response about a news report using only your own opinion instead of the passage's content?

Answer

The response would not demonstrate understanding of the specific passage, since the OSSLT rubric rewards accurate, specific, and relevant ideas drawn from the text itself.

#249 · News Report Reading

Why does a news report almost always include a specific date, time, or number somewhere in the passage?

Answer

Because reported facts, which include checkable details like dates and numbers, are a core feature of objective news writing distinguishing it from opinion or narrative.

#250 · News Report Reading

Why is a headline like 'Local Teen Builds Wheelchair Ramp for Neighbour' considered a strong example headline?

Answer

It hints at both the who (a local teen) and the what (building a wheelchair ramp) of the story, giving the reader a quick frame before reading further.

#251 · News Report Reading

What is the risk of confusing a byline with a dateline?

Answer

The byline tells you who wrote the report, while the dateline tells you where and when the story is set. Mixing the two up can lead to answering an explicit detail question incorrectly.

#252 · News Report Reading

Why does a news report avoid words like 'wonderful' or 'terrible' in the writer's own voice?

Answer

Such emotional words express judgment, which breaks the objective, neutral tone a news report is supposed to maintain outside of quoted material.

#253 · News Report Reading

What is the benefit of predicting the topic of a news report from its headline before reading the lead paragraph?

Answer

It gives your brain a frame to fit the incoming details into, making the Five W's plus How easier and faster to spot as you read.

#254 · News Report Reading

Why might a question ask you to explain 'how' an event happened rather than just 'what' happened in a news report?

Answer

Because the Five W's plus How include both what occurred and the process or method behind it, and a news report often explains both explicitly in the lead or nearby paragraphs.

#255 · News Report Reading

What should you always double check when a news report question involves comparing two different sources' opinions on the same event?

Answer

Confirm which name is attached to each specific quote before answering, since mixing up two sources' opinions is a common and costly mistake.

#256 · Dialogue Reading

What is a dialogue passage on the OSSLT?

Answer

A dialogue passage is written mostly or entirely as a conversation between two or more people, often formatted with short lines and a name or label showing who is speaking.

#257 · Dialogue Reading

What is the most important idea to understand about how a dialogue passage is built?

Answer

It is built on turn-taking: one person speaks, another responds, and meaning comes not just from what is said but from how each person reacts to what the other just said.

#258 · Dialogue Reading

Why might a character's true opinion not appear in their very first line of dialogue?

Answer

It might only become clear two or three exchanges later, once you see how the character responds to pushback or new information.

#259 • Dialogue Reading

What kinds of topics do OSSLT dialogue passages usually cover?

Answer

Realistic, everyday situations such as students disagreeing about a school project, a student talking with a coach or parent, or friends planning an event and hitting a disagreement.

#260 • Dialogue Reading

How does a dialogue passage reveal character differently from a real-life narrative?

Answer

A dialogue passage reveals character through word choice and tone rather than a narrator directly stating a feeling, so the reader must infer emotion from how something is said.

#261 · Dialogue Reading

What are the two common ways a dialogue passage shows who is speaking?

Answer

A name followed by a colon before each line, or traditional dialogue tags inside a narrative, such as 'Jordan said' or 'Priya replied.'

#262 · Dialogue Reading

What is the most common mistake students make when reading a long back-and-forth dialogue passage?

Answer

Mixing up who said what, especially under exam pressure, since it is easy to remember the general disagreement without remembering which speaker held which position.

#263 · Dialogue Reading

What is Strategy 1 for reading a dialogue passage strategically?

Answer

Track who holds which position by asking what each speaker wants and whether they are on opposite sides or actually agree but argue about details.

#264 · Dialogue Reading

What is Strategy 2 for reading a dialogue passage strategically?

Answer

Watch for shifts in tone, since a conversation rarely stays the same from beginning to end and may move from calm to tense or from tense to resolved.

#265 · Dialogue Reading

What is Strategy 3 for reading a dialogue passage strategically?

Answer

Use context clues to infer feelings, paying attention to word choice and what a speaker does NOT say, since dialogue rarely states feelings directly.

#266 · Dialogue Reading

What is Strategy 4 for reading a dialogue passage strategically?

Answer

Separate what is stated from what is inferred, since a stated detail is said outright while an inferred detail is a conclusion drawn from clues in tone or word choice.

#267 · Dialogue Reading

What is Strategy 5 for reading a dialogue passage strategically?

Answer

Follow the conversation to its ending, since many dialogue passages end in an agreement, compromise, or decision that a question will often ask about.

#268 · Dialogue Reading

What are four clues that signal a shift in tone during a dialogue passage?

Answer

Changes in sentence length, changes in punctuation such as a sudden exclamation mark, words showing agreement or backing down like 'Okay, fine,' and interruptions or unfinished sentences.

#269 · Dialogue Reading

Why do short, clipped sentences in dialogue often signal frustration?

Answer

Short sentences often show impatience or frustration, while longer sentences often signal someone trying to persuade or reassure the other speaker.

#270 · Dialogue Reading

What does a sudden exclamation mark after several calm sentences usually signal in dialogue?

Answer

It signals that emotion has increased at that point in the conversation.

#271 · Dialogue Reading

What do phrases like 'Okay, fine' or 'You have a point' usually mark in a dialogue passage?

Answer

They often mark the turning point where a disagreement starts to resolve, showing one speaker beginning to agree or back down.

#272 · Dialogue Reading

What can an interruption or a trailing, unfinished sentence in dialogue suggest?

Answer

It can show a speaker cutting someone off because they are upset, or eager to make a point, and is a deliberate signal the test wants you to notice.

#273 · Dialogue Reading

Why does a line like 'I suppose that could work' sound less enthusiastic than 'That's a great idea, let's do it,' even though both technically agree?

Answer

Word choice reveals tone. The first uses hesitant, lukewarm phrasing while the second uses confident, positive phrasing, even though both express agreement.

#274 · Dialogue Reading

What can it mean when a speaker keeps changing the subject instead of answering a direct question?

Answer

That avoidance itself is a clue, possibly suggesting embarrassment, uncertainty, or an unwillingness to admit something.

#275 · Dialogue Reading

What is the difference between a stated detail and an inferred detail in a dialogue passage?

Answer

A stated detail is something a speaker says outright in the text, while an inferred detail is a conclusion drawn from clues even though no one says it directly.

#276 · Dialogue Reading

What words in a question usually point to a stated detail rather than an inference?

Answer

Words like 'states,' 'says,' or 'explains' usually point to a stated detail you can find directly in the text.

#277 · Dialogue Reading

What words in a question usually point to an inference rather than a stated detail?

Answer

Words like 'suggests,' 'implies,' 'we can infer,' or 'most likely feels' point to an inference question requiring you to interpret clues.

#278 · Dialogue Reading

Why should you always read a dialogue passage all the way to its final lines?

Answer

A question will often ask what the speakers ultimately decide, and a speaker's opinion in the middle of the conversation might change by the end.

#279 · Dialogue Reading

In the science fair dialogue, what does Diego say he completed over the weekend?

Answer

Diego states directly that he finished building the model volcano over the weekend.

#280 · Dialogue Reading

In the science fair dialogue, how does Amara most likely feel about the project at the start of the conversation?

Answer

She is concerned it is too similar to other projects, shown through her question about whether a volcano model will be enough and her comment that many past projects were volcanoes.

#281 • Dialogue Reading

In the science fair dialogue, what do Diego and Amara ultimately decide to do?

Answer

They decide to keep the volcano as it is and add a section testing how different liquids affect the size of the eruption.

#282 • Dialogue Reading

In the science fair dialogue, how does Diego's attitude change over the course of the conversation?

Answer

He starts resistant to changing the project, but becomes open to Amara's idea once she explains her concern about a missing hypothesis.

#283 · Dialogue Reading

In the science fair dialogue, what specific concern does Amara raise about their current project?

Answer

She is worried they do not have a real hypothesis or experiment, since the project so far is just a demonstration rather than a test.

#284 · Dialogue Reading

What is Trap 1 in dialogue passage questions?

Answer

Mixing up which speaker said what, especially in a conversation with several exchanges, which is the single most common mistake on dialogue questions.

#285 · Dialogue Reading

What is Trap 2 in dialogue passage questions?

Answer

Missing a shift in tone or opinion partway through the conversation, which can happen if you only read the first half carefully and skim the rest.

#286 · Dialogue Reading

What is Trap 3 in dialogue passage questions?

Answer

Confusing a strong statement made in the middle of a conversation with the final outcome, when the true ending may actually be a compromise.

#287 · Dialogue Reading

What is Trap 4 in dialogue passage questions?

Answer

Treating an inference question like a detail question, expecting an exact quote to state a feeling directly rather than interpreting clues from tone and word choice.

#288 · Dialogue Reading

What is Trap 5 in dialogue passage questions?

Answer

Picking an answer that sounds dramatic but is not supported, such as calling a character 'angry' when the text only shows mild disagreement.

#289 · Dialogue Reading

What is Trap 6 in dialogue passage questions?

Answer

Ignoring formatting clues like interruptions, trailing sentences, or unusual punctuation, which are placed deliberately and often hold the key to a tone question.

#290 · Dialogue Reading

What five items belong on a quick review checklist before finishing a dialogue passage?

Answer

Did you track who holds which position, notice any tone shift, read to the true ending, look beyond direct statements for feelings, and confirm details against the actual passage lines?

#291 • Dialogue Reading

Why is it risky to answer an outcome question using a dramatic statement from the middle of a dialogue?

Answer

Because the true resolution comes from the conversation's final lines, and a strong mid-conversation statement, like early resistance, is often reversed by the end.

#292 • Dialogue Reading

How should you match the intensity of an answer choice to a dialogue passage's actual tone?

Answer

Match the emotional strength of the answer choice to what is actually shown in the text, avoiding options that exaggerate a character's feelings beyond what is supported.

#293 · Dialogue Reading

Why do dialogue passages test inference skills more directly than other passage types?

Answer

Because characters' feelings and opinions are shown through word choice and tone rather than a narrator stating them outright, requiring the reader to infer meaning.

#294 · Dialogue Reading

What is one practical way to keep track of two speakers' opposing positions while reading a dialogue passage?

Answer

Mentally sort each speaker's lines into a 'position' bucket as you read, or jot a quick one-word note if working on paper, to avoid attributing one speaker's opinion to the other.

#295 • Dialogue Reading

Why is it important to notice both what a speaker says and what they choose not to say?

Answer

Avoidance, like changing the subject or refusing to answer directly, can itself be a meaningful clue about a speaker's feelings, such as discomfort or uncertainty.

#296 • Dialogue Reading

How many selected-response questions typically accompany a dialogue passage on the OSSLT?

Answer

Five selected-response questions typically accompany a dialogue passage.

#297 · Dialogue Reading

Why does formatting like a name followed by a colon matter when reading a dialogue passage?

Answer

It tells you exactly which character is speaking each line, and losing track of this formatting under time pressure is a common source of careless mistakes.

#298 · Dialogue Reading

What kind of ending do many OSSLT dialogue passages have?

Answer

Many dialogue passages end with some kind of resolution, such as an agreement, a compromise, or a clear decision between the speakers.

#299 · Dialogue Reading

Why should you avoid assuming a speaker's opinion is fixed based only on their first line?

Answer

A speaker's opinion can shift after hearing new information or pushback, so the true final position may only be clear from later lines in the conversation.

#300 · Dialogue Reading

How does a longer sentence in dialogue typically differ in tone from a short, clipped one?

Answer

A longer sentence often signals someone trying to persuade or reassure, while a short, clipped sentence often signals frustration or impatience.

#301 • Dialogue Reading

Why is 'we can infer' language in a question a signal to look beyond the literal words of the dialogue?

Answer

It tells you the answer requires interpreting tone, word choice, or behaviour rather than finding an exact quote stating the answer directly.

#302 • Dialogue Reading

What should you do before selecting an answer about which speaker holds a certain opinion?

Answer

Go back to the passage and confirm which name is actually attached to that specific line before choosing your answer.

#303 · Dialogue Reading

Why is Diego's line 'We don't have time to start over' not the final outcome of the science fair dialogue?

Answer

It reflects his early resistance in the middle of the conversation, but by the end he agrees to a compromise, so this line does not represent the true final decision.

#304 · Dialogue Reading

What does Amara's line 'I'm worried we'll lose marks for not having a real hypothesis' reveal about her priorities?

Answer

It reveals she values having a properly designed experiment and is concerned about following the actual requirements of a science fair project.

#305 • Dialogue Reading

Why is a compromise, rather than one speaker simply winning, a common ending for OSSLT dialogue passages?

Answer

These passages are built around realistic everyday disagreements, and a compromise reflects a believable, relatable way two reasonable people resolve a disagreement.

#306 • Dialogue Reading

What is a helpful mental question to ask yourself whenever a dialogue speaker says something emotionally charged?

Answer

Ask why the speaker is reacting that way and what clue it gives about their underlying feeling, rather than only noting the words on the surface.

#307 · Dialogue Reading

Why might two dialogue passages use different formatting styles, such as a script style versus a narrative style with tags?

Answer

Both formats are common on the OSSLT, and while the visual style differs, the reading skill required, tracking who says what, stays the same either way.

#308 · Dialogue Reading

What does the word 'turn-taking' describe in a dialogue passage?

Answer

It describes the back-and-forth structure of a conversation, where meaning builds through each speaker's response to what was just said before.

#309 · Dialogue Reading

Why should you slow down when a dialogue passage includes a sudden change in punctuation, like an exclamation mark?

Answer

A sudden change in punctuation is a deliberate signal of increased emotion, and slowing down helps you catch the tone shift before answering a related question.

#310 · Dialogue Reading

How can you tell if a character's opinion in a dialogue has genuinely shifted rather than just repeated itself?

Answer

Compare the character's specific wording and attitude near the start of the conversation to their wording and attitude near the end, watching for words that show agreement or backing down.

#311 • Dialogue Reading

Why does the OSSLT include dialogue passages about disagreements rather than only friendly conversations?

Answer

Disagreements naturally require tracking two different positions, tone shifts, and eventual resolutions, all of which let the test assess several reading skills at once.

#312 • Dialogue Reading

What should you do if a dialogue passage question asks about a speaker's 'overall attitude'?

Answer

Consider the whole conversation from start to finish rather than basing your answer only on the speaker's very first line, since attitudes often shift.

#313 • Dialogue Reading

How is 'stated' different from 'suggested' when describing dialogue in an OSSLT question?

Answer

Stated means a speaker says it outright in the text, while suggested means the idea is only implied through tone, word choice, or behaviour rather than said directly.

#314 • Dialogue Reading

Why is it a mistake to assume a dialogue passage's outcome will match its opening tone?

Answer

Because a conversation can move from tension to agreement or from calm to conflict, so the ending must be confirmed by reading the actual closing lines.

#315 • Dialogue Reading

What might it mean if a dialogue passage shows a speaker's sentences getting shorter as the conversation continues?

Answer

It could signal growing frustration, impatience, or discomfort, since shortened, clipped responses are a common tone-shift clue in dialogue passages.

#316 • Dialogue Reading

Why is it useful to ask 'what does Speaker A want?' and 'what does Speaker B want?' early in a dialogue passage?

Answer

It helps you quickly identify each character's position, which makes it easier to track how their views develop or change throughout the conversation.

#317 • Dialogue Reading

What is the danger of assuming both speakers in a dialogue are equally invested in an outcome?

Answer

One speaker might care deeply while the other seems indifferent or uncertain, and questions may test whether you can identify these differences in investment or feeling.

#318 • Dialogue Reading

Why does the OSSLT test dialogue passages using realistic school or family situations instead of unfamiliar topics?

Answer

So that a Grade 10 student can relate to the situation without needing outside knowledge, since everything needed to answer the questions is inside the conversation itself.

#319 · Dialogue Reading

What is the best way to prepare for a question asking why a speaker changed their mind in a dialogue?

Answer

Trace the conversation from the point of disagreement to the moment of the shift, noting the specific words or reasoning that caused the change in position.

#320 · Dialogue Reading

Why should you never guess a dialogue answer choice just because it feels emotionally intense?

Answer

Because the correct answer must match the intensity actually shown in the text, and an overly dramatic choice that is not supported by the dialogue will be incorrect.

#321 • Dialogue Reading

What is one reason dialogue passages sometimes use dashes or trailing sentences?

Answer

To show a speaker being interrupted or trailing off, which is a deliberate signal of emotion or urgency that the test wants readers to notice.

#322 • Dialogue Reading

Why might a dialogue between a student and a coach or parent be used to test reading comprehension?

Answer

It presents a realistic authority-versus-student dynamic that naturally creates differing positions, tone shifts, and a decision, which lets the test assess multiple reading skills.

#323 · Dialogue Reading

What is a practical first step when a dialogue passage opens mid-disagreement?

Answer

Quickly identify what each speaker already believes or wants before reading further, so you have a frame for understanding how their positions develop.

#324 · Dialogue Reading

Why is it important to notice which speaker proposes the final compromise in a dialogue passage?

Answer

Because a question about the resolution may ask specifically who suggested the final plan, and misattributing the idea to the wrong speaker is a common trap.

#325 · Dialogue Reading

What does it mean if a dialogue passage question says a speaker's tone is 'measured' compared to 'heated'?

Answer

A measured tone stays calm and controlled while a heated tone shows rising emotion or urgency, and the correct answer should match the actual intensity shown in the lines.

#326 · Dialogue Reading

Why should a reader avoid over-interpreting a single word choice in isolation during a dialogue passage?

Answer

A single word can be ambiguous on its own, so the safest inference comes from combining several clues, such as sentence length, punctuation, and word choice together.

#327 · Dialogue Reading

What is a reliable way to confirm you have correctly identified the passage's resolution?

Answer

Reread the final two or three lines of the dialogue specifically, since the true outcome is almost always confirmed there rather than earlier in the conversation.

#328 · Dialogue Reading

Why does the OSSLT dialogue chapter emphasize checking exact lines before answering rather than relying on a general impression?

Answer

Because dialogue passages often have several exchanges, and a general impression can easily blur which speaker said which specific detail.

#329 · Dialogue Reading

What kind of question would ask 'What does Priya's response suggest about her approach to deadlines?'

Answer

An inference question, since the word 'suggest' signals that the answer must be reasoned from Priya's tone and word choice rather than found as a direct statement.

#330 · Dialogue Reading

Why can a dialogue passage's ending feel different from its beginning even though no narrator explains the change?

Answer

Because tone shifts in dialogue are shown entirely through word choice, punctuation, and how each speaker responds to the other, without any narrator stating the change directly.

#331 · Writing Selected-Response

What does the word 'conventions' mean on the OSSLT?

Answer

Conventions means the normal rules of written English: spelling, grammar, and punctuation, which help writing make sense to a reader.

#332 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the key idea EQAO uses when scoring conventions?

Answer

Errors matter most when they get in the way of communication. A small typo a reader can see past is less serious than an error that actually confuses meaning.

#333 · Writing Selected-Response

Give an example of a convention error that confuses meaning rather than just looking like a typo.

Answer

Mixing up 'it's' and 'its,' as in 'The dog bit the man who was running from it's owner,' which genuinely confuses who owns what.

#334 · Writing Selected-Response

What does 'organization' mean on the OSSLT writing section?

Answer

Organization is about how ideas are arranged, not individual words or punctuation, including whether there is a clear topic sentence and a logical sentence order.

#335 · Writing Selected-Response

What four features make up good paragraph organization?

Answer

A topic sentence stating the main idea, supporting details in logical order, transition words showing how ideas connect, and a conclusion or closing idea.

#336 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the rule for subject-verb agreement?

Answer

The subject of a sentence and its verb need to match in number: a singular subject takes a singular verb, and a plural subject takes a plural verb.

#337 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'The list of items is on the table' correct rather than 'The list of items are on the table'?

Answer

The subject is 'list,' which is singular, not 'items,' even though 'items' sits closer to the verb, so the verb must agree with 'list.'

#338 · Writing Selected-Response

What problem does the sentence 'Sarah told her sister that she had won the contest' have?

Answer

It is confusing pronoun use, since it is unclear whether 'she' refers to Sarah or her sister.

#339 · Writing Selected-Response

How can you fix unclear pronoun reference, using the Sarah and her sister example?

Answer

Replace the unclear pronoun with the actual noun it refers to, or rewrite using a direct quotation, such as 'Sarah told her sister, "I won the contest."'

#340 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between a subject pronoun and an object pronoun?

Answer

Subject pronouns (I, he, she, we, they) perform the action, while object pronouns (me, him, her, us, them) receive the action.

#341 • Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'My friend and I went to the store' correct rather than 'Me and my friend went to the store'?

Answer

'I' is the subject pronoun performing the action of going, while 'me' is an object pronoun, so 'I' is correct as the subject.

#342 • Writing Selected-Response

What trick can you use to check whether 'I' or 'me' is correct in a sentence with two people?

Answer

Remove the other person from the sentence and see if it still sounds right, since 'Me went to the store' clearly sounds wrong.

#343 · Writing Selected-Response

What is a comma splice?

Answer

A comma splice happens when two complete sentences are joined with only a comma and nothing else, such as 'The rain started, we went inside.'

#344 · Writing Selected-Response

What is a run-on sentence?

Answer

A run-on sentence happens when two complete sentences are joined with no punctuation at all, such as 'The rain started we went inside.'

#345 · Writing Selected-Response

Name four ways to fix a comma splice or run-on sentence.

Answer

Add a period to make two sentences, add a comma plus a coordinating conjunction, add a semicolon, or turn one clause into a dependent clause.

#346 · Writing Selected-Response

What are the seven coordinating conjunctions used to fix a comma splice?

Answer

And, but, or, so, for, nor, and yet.

#347 · Writing Selected-Response

What is a sentence fragment?

Answer

A sentence fragment is a group of words that looks like a sentence but is missing something needed to be complete, usually a subject, a verb, or a complete thought.

#348 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'Because she was late for school' a fragment rather than a complete sentence?

Answer

It sets up a dependent clause but never completes the thought, so it needs an independent clause attached, such as 'Because she was late for school, she missed the bus.'

#349 · Writing Selected-Response

What are the main jobs of a comma?

Answer

Separating items in a list, separating an introductory phrase from the main sentence, setting off extra information, and joining two sentences with a conjunction.

#350 · Writing Selected-Response

What are the two main jobs of an apostrophe?

Answer

Showing possession, meaning something belongs to someone, and forming a contraction by joining two words into one shorter word.

#351 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'I have three cat's' incorrect?

Answer

An apostrophe should not be added just to make a word plural. The correct plural form is 'cats,' with no apostrophe.

#352 · Writing Selected-Response

How should quotation marks be punctuated when introducing a person's exact words?

Answer

A comma comes before the quotation mark, and the quoted sentence begins with a capital letter, as in 'She said, "I will be there at noon."'

#353 · Writing Selected-Response

What are homophones?

Answer

Homophones are words that sound the same but have different spellings and meanings, such as their, there, and they're.

#354 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between their, there, and they're?

Answer

Their shows possession, there refers to a place or introduces a sentence, and they're is a contraction of 'they are.'

#355 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between its and it's?

Answer

Its shows possession, as in 'The dog wagged its tail,' while it's is a contraction of 'it is' or 'it has,' as in 'It's raining outside.'

#356 · Writing Selected-Response

What trick helps decide between its and it's?

Answer

If you can replace the word with 'it is' and the sentence still makes sense, use the apostrophe form 'it's.' If not, use 'its' without an apostrophe.

#357 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between your and you're?

Answer

Your shows possession, as in 'Is this your backpack?' while you're is a contraction of 'you are,' as in 'You're going to be late.'

#358 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between affect and effect?

Answer

Affect is usually a verb meaning to influence something, while effect is usually a noun meaning a result.

#359 · Writing Selected-Response

What memory trick helps distinguish affect from effect?

Answer

Affect is an Action (both start with A), and effect is the End result (both start with E).

#360 · Writing Selected-Response

What is a topic sentence's role in paragraph organization?

Answer

A topic sentence introduces the main idea of a paragraph and should be broad enough to cover the whole paragraph but specific enough to tell the reader what it is about.

#361 · Writing Selected-Response

What is meant by 'logical paragraph order'?

Answer

Sentences and paragraphs need to follow a sensible order, such as chronological order, the order of steps in a process, or general ideas moving to specific details.

#362 · Writing Selected-Response

What do transition words do in a paragraph?

Answer

Transition words act like road signs, telling the reader what kind of idea is coming next, such as a contrast, a result, an additional point, or a change in time.

#363 · Writing Selected-Response

What do the words 'however,' 'on the other hand,' and 'in contrast' signal?

Answer

They signal a contrast or a change in direction in the ideas being presented.

#364 · Writing Selected-Response

What do the words 'therefore,' 'as a result,' and 'consequently' signal?

Answer

They signal a result or a conclusion following from what was just said.

#365 · Writing Selected-Response

What do the words 'in addition,' 'furthermore,' and 'also' signal?

Answer

They signal that another similar point is coming, adding to what was already said.

#366 · Writing Selected-Response

What do the words 'for example,' 'for instance,' and 'such as' signal?

Answer

They signal that a specific example is coming to illustrate the point just made.

#367 · Writing Selected-Response

What do the words 'meanwhile,' 'after that,' 'next,' and 'finally' signal?

Answer

They signal a change in time or sequence, showing how events or steps relate chronologically.

#368 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the process for removing an irrelevant sentence from a paragraph?

Answer

Identify the sentence that goes off topic and does not support the paragraph's main idea, even if it is interesting on its own, and remove it.

#369 · Writing Selected-Response

When should two short, choppy sentences be combined into one?

Answer

When they communicate more clearly together than as two separate, disconnected statements, such as combining 'The dog was hungry. The dog waited by its bowl' into one sentence.

#370 · Writing Selected-Response

When should a long, overloaded sentence be split into two?

Answer

When a sentence tries to pack too many ideas together with repeated 'and's, making it clearer to separate the ideas into two properly punctuated sentences.

#371 · Writing Selected-Response

In the bus example, why is 'The bus arrived late, so the students missed their first class' the best revision of a comma splice?

Answer

It correctly adds the coordinating conjunction 'so,' linking the cause (the bus was late) to the result (students missed class) without leaving a comma splice.

#372 · Writing Selected-Response

In the Jenna example, how is unclear pronoun reference best fixed?

Answer

By replacing the ambiguous pronoun with the specific noun it refers to, such as changing 'she thanked her' to 'her mother thanked her,' removing any confusion about who is doing what.

#373 · Writing Selected-Response

In the recycling paragraph example, which sentence should be removed and why?

Answer

The sentence about a hobby of collecting comic books should be removed because it is about a completely different topic and does not support the paragraph's main idea about recycling.

#374 · Writing Selected-Response

In the plastic-reduction paragraph example, what is the correct logical order of the four sentences?

Answer

Introduce the campaign, explain how it began with posters, explain the result using 'as a result,' and finish with the final outcome of less garbage.

#375 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about subject-verb agreement when reviewing a sentence?

Answer

Does the subject match the verb, especially when another phrase sits between them that might tempt you to match the verb to the wrong noun?

#376 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about pronouns when reviewing a sentence?

Answer

Is it clear which specific noun each pronoun in the sentence refers to, with no ambiguity about who is being talked about?

#377 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about sentence completeness when reviewing writing?

Answer

Is every group of words a complete sentence, containing a subject, a verb, and a complete thought, with no fragments?

#378 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about commas, apostrophes, and quotation marks when reviewing writing?

Answer

Are commas, apostrophes, and quotation marks used correctly for their specific jobs, such as possession, contraction, or setting off quoted speech?

#379 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about homophones when reviewing writing?

Answer

Are commonly confused homophones such as their/there/they're, its/it's, your/you're, and effect/affect used correctly throughout the writing?

#380 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about topic sentences when reviewing paragraph organization?

Answer

Is there a clear topic sentence that tells the reader what the paragraph is about, usually placed first?

#381 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about sentence order when reviewing paragraph organization?

Answer

Are the sentences arranged in a logical order that a reader could easily follow, such as chronological or general-to-specific order?

#382 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about transitions when reviewing paragraph organization?

Answer

Do the transition words correctly signal how ideas connect, such as contrast, result, addition, example, or sequence?

#383 • Writing Selected-Response

What checklist question should you ask about paragraph focus when reviewing organization?

Answer

Does every sentence belong to the same main idea, or is there a sentence that goes off topic and should be removed?

#384 • Writing Selected-Response

How many questions on the OSSLT test writing conventions and organization through selected response?

Answer

Twelve questions test conventions and organization, using formats like choosing the best fix, dragging sentences into order, or picking the best word from a drop-down list.

#385 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is a small spelling slip like 'recieve' for 'receive' considered less serious under the OSSLT conventions rubric?

Answer

Because the reader still understands the intended word, so the error does not get in the way of communication even though it is technically incorrect.

#386 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the underlying goal behind every OSSLT conventions question that asks for the 'best' revision?

Answer

To identify which version communicates the idea most clearly and correctly, even when more than one option might be grammatically acceptable.

#387 • Writing Selected-Response

Why does inserting a phrase between a subject and a verb create a common agreement error?

Answer

The eye is tempted to match the verb to the closest noun in the inserted phrase rather than to the true subject of the sentence, causing a mismatch.

#388 • Writing Selected-Response

What kind of question format asks you to select the correct word to complete a sentence from a small list, such as *their/there/they're*?

Answer

A drop-down menu style question testing homophone or word choice knowledge within a sentence.

#389 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'Theyre' an incorrect spelling in a drop-down homophone question?

Answer

It is missing the apostrophe needed to correctly form the contraction 'they're,' meaning 'they are.'

#390 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the purpose of a coordinating conjunction like 'so' when fixing a comma splice?

Answer

It correctly links two independent clauses by showing the logical relationship between them, such as cause and effect, rather than joining them with only a comma.

#391 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does a semicolon work as a fix for a comma splice?

Answer

A semicolon can join two closely related independent clauses without needing a conjunction, correctly separating the two complete thoughts while showing they are connected.

#392 · Writing Selected-Response

What happens when a dependent clause like 'When the rain started' is used to fix a comma splice?

Answer

It turns one of the two complete sentences into a dependent clause, so the sentence now has one main idea supported by an introductory clause instead of two spliced sentences.

#393 · Writing Selected-Response

How would you fix the fragment 'Running down the street as fast as he could'?

Answer

Add a subject and helping verb to complete the thought, such as 'He was running down the street as fast as he could.'

#394 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'My brother, who is in Grade 12, plays hockey' punctuated correctly with commas?

Answer

The commas set off the extra information about the brother being in Grade 12, which is not essential to the main sentence but adds detail.

#395 · Writing Selected-Response

What is wrong with a paragraph that has a clear topic sentence but jumbled sentence order?

Answer

The reader has to work hard to piece together the meaning, and sometimes the meaning gets lost completely, even though each individual sentence may be well written.

#396 · Writing Selected-Response

What writing skill does Chapter 7 focus on, alongside organization and conventions?

Answer

Developing a main idea with sufficient supporting details, one of the three writing skills EQAO measures on the OSSLT.

#397 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between a topic and a claim?

Answer

A topic is a subject area that does not take a position, such as 'part-time jobs,' while a claim is a specific statement that says something about the topic and can be agreed or disagreed with.

#398 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'This paragraph is about part-time jobs' too vague to be a main idea?

Answer

It only names a topic and takes no position, so there is nothing for a reader to agree with, disagree with, or ask you to prove.

#399 · Writing Selected-Response

What three qualities does a strong main idea usually have?

Answer

It is specific, it is arguable or explainable, and it fits in one clear sentence.

#400 · Writing Selected-Response

Why must a strong main idea fit in one sentence?

Answer

If you cannot state your main idea in one clear sentence, you are usually trying to cover too many ideas at once, and you should save the extra idea for another paragraph.

#401 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the 'so what?' test for checking whether you have written a real claim?

Answer

Asking 'so what?' after your sentence. If it is just a label for a topic, there is nothing to defend, but if it is a real claim, 'so what?' leads directly into your supporting details.

#402 · Writing Selected-Response

What does EQAO mean by 'sufficient supporting details'?

Answer

Sufficient means there is enough support, and that the support is specific enough to actually convince a reader, since one vague detail is not enough.

#403 · Writing Selected-Response

What does it mean for a detail to be 'supporting' rather than just true?

Answer

A supporting detail is directly connected to the main idea, giving evidence, a reason, an example, or a fact that backs up the claim, rather than unrelated extra information.

#404 · Writing Selected-Response

Name four types of filler that weaken a paragraph.

Answer

Vague statements that could apply to anything, repetition restating the same point in different words, general claims with no specific example, and true details that do not connect back to the main idea.

#405 · Writing Selected-Response

Name four features of a real supporting detail.

Answer

A specific example with names or numbers, a concrete reason explaining WHY the main idea is true, a checkable fact, and a detail that clearly links back to the claim.

#406 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the 'delete test' for spotting filler in a paragraph?

Answer

If you could delete a sentence and the paragraph would lose no real information, that sentence was filler. If deleting it would leave a hole in the argument, it was doing real work.

#407 · Writing Selected-Response

What three parts make up a strong paragraph?

Answer

The topic sentence, the supporting sentences, and the concluding or transition sentence.

#408 · Writing Selected-Response

Where should the topic sentence go in OSSLT writing, and why?

Answer

First, since putting it first is the clearest, safest structure and tells the reader exactly what is coming.

#409 · Writing Selected-Response

How many supporting sentences does a strong paragraph typically include?

Answer

Usually two to four sentences, each giving a specific detail, example, reason, or fact that backs up the topic sentence.

#410 · Writing Selected-Response

What should a concluding sentence do, according to Chapter 7?

Answer

It should wrap up the paragraph's point or connect smoothly to what comes next, without simply repeating the topic sentence word for word.

#411 · Writing Selected-Response

Why was the weak paragraph about part-time jobs considered weak?

Answer

Its opening sentence was a topic dressed up as a claim, every supporting sentence repeated the same vague idea in different words, and the conclusion just restated the opening.

#412 · Writing Selected-Response

What made the strong paragraph about part-time jobs effective?

Answer

Its topic sentence named the exact skill and previewed categories of evidence, each supporting sentence gave a different concrete detail, and the conclusion extended the idea rather than repeating it.

#413 · Writing Selected-Response

What is Step 1 of building a paragraph, according to Chapter 7?

Answer

Brainstorm and state your main idea as a claim, pushing past the first vague sentence that comes to mind to name a specific reason.

#414 · Writing Selected-Response

What is Step 2 of building a paragraph, according to Chapter 7?

Answer

Generate three specific supporting details, asking yourself 'can I picture this?' and 'is this different from my other details?' for each one.

#415 · Writing Selected-Response

What is Step 3 of building a paragraph, according to Chapter 7?

Answer

Arrange the details logically, such as moving from the most concrete everyday detail to the most impressive one, or grouping similar ideas together.

#416 · Writing Selected-Response

What is Step 4 of building a paragraph, according to Chapter 7?

Answer

Write a concluding sentence that sums up why the evidence matters or points toward an action, rather than copying the topic sentence.

#417 · Writing Selected-Response

In the environmental club example, what three genuinely different supporting details are given?

Answer

The composting program cutting cafeteria garbage, members learning hands-on skills like gardening and soil testing, and the club representing the school at a regional competition.

#418 · Writing Selected-Response

Why do the three environmental club details work well together?

Answer

They cover three different angles, waste reduction, skill building, and school reputation, rather than being three versions of the same idea.

#419 · Writing Selected-Response

In Practice Question 1 about cooking, why is the pasta and stir-fry option the best supporting sentence?

Answer

It gives a specific, concrete example and directly connects it to a real benefit, saving money instead of relying on expensive takeout, which supports the claim about a useful life skill.

#420 · Writing Selected-Response

In Practice Question 2 about sleep, which sentence does not belong, and why?

Answer

The sentence about students enjoying staying up late does not belong, since it explains a cause of poor sleep rather than supporting the claim that sleep improves school performance.

#421 • Writing Selected-Response

In Practice Question 3 about group projects, why is the scheduling example the best supporting sentence?

Answer

It gives a specific scenario, a student organizing meetings, and explains exactly what teamwork skill the group learns, shared responsibility keeping a project on track.

#422 • Writing Selected-Response

In Practice Question 4 about volunteering and empathy, which sentence does not belong, and why?

Answer

The sentence about food banks relying on volunteer labour does not belong, since it is about the food bank's operations rather than what a student learns or feels while volunteering.

#423 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'Cooking can be fun and some people really enjoy it' a weak supporting sentence for the claim that cooking teaches a life skill?

Answer

It is vague and does not connect to the specific idea of a 'life skill,' focusing on enjoyment instead of the skill being developed.

#424 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is a general true fact, like 'group projects are common in classes,' not strong support for a teamwork claim?

Answer

It does not explain HOW group projects build teamwork skills, so it fails to connect specifically to the claim even though it is a true statement.

#425 · Writing Selected-Response

What five habits should you keep in mind every time you build a paragraph, according to Chapter 7?

Answer

Turn your topic into a claim first, give each supporting sentence a specific job, ask 'can I picture this?' for every detail, order details logically, and end with a sentence that adds something new.

#426 · Writing Selected-Response

Why should two supporting sentences never do the same job in a paragraph?

Answer

If two sentences repeat the same point, one should be cut and replaced with a genuinely different angle, since repetition does not add new evidence.

#427 · Writing Selected-Response

What question can you ask to test whether a supporting detail is specific enough?

Answer

Can I picture this? If the answer is no, the detail is too vague to count as real evidence.

#428 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does Chapter 7 recommend ordering supporting details logically instead of randomly?

Answer

A logical order, such as building from the daily impact to the personal impact to the outward impact, makes the argument easier for a reader to follow and feel convinced by.

#429 · Writing Selected-Response

How does the concluding sentence in the strong part-time job paragraph avoid simply repeating the topic sentence?

Answer

It extends the idea forward by connecting the paragraph's point to adulthood, rather than restating that part-time jobs teach responsibility.

#430 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the risk of writing a main idea that is a plain fact nobody would question?

Answer

There is nothing left to support or prove, since a good main idea should be arguable or explainable enough to require evidence.

#431 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'Part-time jobs teach teenagers responsibility because they force students to manage their own time, money, and commitments' a stronger main idea than 'Part-time jobs are good'?

Answer

It is specific, naming the exact skill (responsibility) and reasons (time, money, commitments), rather than making a vague, unspecific claim.

#432 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the connection between Chapter 7's paragraph-building skills and the opinion essay in Chapter 8?

Answer

The same skills used to build one strong paragraph, a claim supported by specific details, are used repeatedly to build each body paragraph of a full multi-paragraph opinion essay.

#433 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does a paragraph lose credibility when every supporting sentence restates the same vague idea?

Answer

A reader finishes the paragraph knowing nothing more than before, since no new evidence or angle was actually added beyond the initial vague claim.

#434 · Writing Selected-Response

What kind of supporting detail would most likely lose marks even though it is factually true?

Answer

A detail that is true but does not connect back to the specific main idea, since it fails to actually support the claim being made.

#435 • Writing Selected-Response

Why is naming a specific number, name, or moment more convincing than a general statement in a supporting sentence?

Answer

Specific details let a reader picture a real situation clearly, while general statements like 'it helps a lot of people' could apply to almost any topic and prove nothing.

#436 • Writing Selected-Response

How should you handle a supporting detail idea that feels the same as one you already used?

Answer

Replace it with a genuinely different angle, since Chapter 7 recommends asking 'is this different from my other details?' before including it.

#437 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is a paragraph's concluding sentence important even though it does not add new evidence?

Answer

It shows the point has been proven or points the reader toward what comes next, giving the paragraph a sense of completion rather than an abrupt stop.

#438 · Writing Selected-Response

What percentage of the total OSSLT score does the opinion essay represent?

Answer

The opinion essay is worth 25 percent of the total OSSLT score.

#439 · Writing Selected-Response

What does an OSSLT opinion prompt typically ask you to do?

Answer

It gives a topic or statement and asks you to agree or disagree, or take a position on a question, usually one built to have two reasonable sides.

#440 · Writing Selected-Response

Why are OSSLT opinion prompts built to have two reasonable sides?

Answer

Because the test is not checking whether you land on the 'right' opinion, it is checking whether you can state an opinion clearly and support it with real reasons.

#441 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the single biggest mistake students make on the opinion essay task?

Answer

Trying to sit on the fence by saying 'there are good points on both sides' without committing to one clear position.

#442 · Writing Selected-Response

What happens to your score if your opinion wavers or contradicts itself between paragraphs?

Answer

You lose marks on the Topic Development rubric even if your grammar is perfect, since the rubric specifically rewards a clear and consistent opinion.

#443 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the fast method for picking a side on an opinion prompt under time pressure?

Answer

Read the prompt twice, then ask which side you can think of two or three specific reasons for right now, and pick that side rather than the side you personally believe in most.

#444 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does Chapter 8 say to pick the side that is easier to argue rather than your true personal belief?

Answer

The exam is testing your writing and reasoning skills within a timed first draft, not collecting your genuine life philosophy, so the easier-to-argue side is a valid strategic choice.

#445 · Writing Selected-Response

What is a useful habit once you pick your side for an opinion essay?

Answer

Write it down as a short plan note before starting your introduction, such as 'Opinion: agree, volunteer hours should be required,' to avoid drifting into the other side by accident.

#446 · Writing Selected-Response

How many paragraphs make up the repeatable structure recommended for the opinion essay?

Answer

Five paragraphs: an introduction, two or three body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

#447 · Writing Selected-Response

What should the introduction paragraph of an opinion essay include?

Answer

The topic stated in one sentence, your opinion stated clearly in the next sentence, and optionally a brief mention of your two or three main reasons.

#448 · Writing Selected-Response

How long should the introduction and conclusion paragraphs of an opinion essay be?

Answer

Both should be kept short, with the introduction around three to five sentences and the conclusion around three to four sentences.

#449 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the pattern for each body paragraph of an opinion essay?

Answer

State the reason in one sentence, then spend the rest of the paragraph explaining it with a specific detail, example, or piece of reasoning, without just repeating the reason in different words.

#450 · Writing Selected-Response

Is a third body paragraph required in the opinion essay structure?

Answer

It is optional but recommended if you have time, since a third reason strengthens the essay, though two strong body paragraphs with real detail beat three thin ones.

#451 · Writing Selected-Response

What should the conclusion paragraph of an opinion essay do?

Answer

Restate the opinion in different words than the introduction, briefly sum up the main reasons, and end with a closing thought.

#452 · Writing Selected-Response

What three chunks of time should you plan for when writing a timed opinion essay?

Answer

Planning, writing, and reviewing.

#453 · Writing Selected-Response

What should happen during the planning stage of an opinion essay?

Answer

Read the prompt, pick your side, and jot down your opinion plus two or three reasons in point form, without writing full sentences yet.

#454 · Writing Selected-Response

What should you do during the writing stage of an opinion essay?

Answer

Work through your five paragraphs in order following your plan, without stopping to fix small spelling mistakes, since those can be fixed during review.

#455 · Writing Selected-Response

What should you check during the reviewing stage of an opinion essay?

Answer

Fix obvious spelling and punctuation errors, confirm your opinion is stated clearly and consistently in both the introduction and conclusion, and check each body paragraph has a specific detail.

#456 · Writing Selected-Response

What does the Topic Development rubric want beyond just an opinion?

Answer

It wants the opinion developed with sufficient, specific, and thoughtfully chosen details, not just a vague statement left unsupported.

#457 · Writing Selected-Response

What are the three quick sources of specific detail suggested for generating essay content quickly?

Answer

Personal experience, observation, and logical reasoning.

#458 · Writing Selected-Response

What is 'personal experience' as a source of essay detail?

Answer

Drawing on something you or someone you know has done related to the topic, even a small real or realistic example works.

#459 · Writing Selected-Response

What is 'observation' as a source of essay detail?

Answer

Noticing something that has happened around you, at school or in your community, that relates to the essay topic.

#460 · Writing Selected-Response

What is 'logical reasoning' as a source of essay detail?

Answer

Walking through the cause and effect of your point step by step, explaining a chain of reasoning from one idea to its consequence.

#461 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'It helps people' considered a weak detail compared to a specific alternative?

Answer

It is too vague to picture, while a specific detail names exactly what is learned or how it happens, such as building confidence for job interviews through practising conversations with adults.

#462 · Writing Selected-Response

What question should you ask after writing each reason in an opinion essay to strengthen it?

Answer

Can I add one more sentence that gives an example or explains exactly how or why this happens? That extra sentence often moves a paragraph from a mid-range mark to a top mark.

#463 · Writing Selected-Response

Out of how many points is the Topic Development rubric scored, and in what increments?

Answer

The Topic Development rubric is scored from 0 to 60, in steps of 10.

#464 · Writing Selected-Response

What four questions does the Topic Development rubric really ask, in plain language?

Answer

Is your opinion clear? Is your opinion consistent?
Do you have enough specific supporting details? Is your essay organized with a logical flow?

#465 · Writing Selected-Response

What does it mean for an opinion to be 'clear' under the Topic Development rubric?

Answer

A marker should be able to state your opinion in one sentence after reading your introduction, without having to guess.

#466 · Writing Selected-Response

What does it mean for an opinion to be 'consistent' under the Topic Development rubric?

Answer

Your position should not contradict itself, such as arguing for a phone ban in one paragraph and against it in another.

#467 · Writing Selected-Response

What happens to an essay with a missing or unclear opinion and thin details, according to Chapter 8?

Answer

It lands in the lower bands of the Topic Development rubric no matter how correct the spelling is, since the rubric is about thinking and structure, not surface polish.

#468 · Writing Selected-Response

Out of how many points is the Conventions rubric scored, and in what increments?

Answer

The Conventions rubric is scored from 0 to 40, in steps of 10.

#469 · Writing Selected-Response

What does the Conventions rubric actually check, according to Chapter 8?

Answer

Whether errors get in the way of understanding your ideas, since the writing is scored as first-draft writing, not expected to be flawless or publication-level.

#470 · Writing Selected-Response

What specific length rule affects the Conventions rubric score?

Answer

A response under 30 words automatically scores at the bottom band on the Conventions rubric, regardless of how correct those words are.

#471 • Writing Selected-Response

Why should you never submit a one or two sentence opinion response, even if very short on time?

Answer

Because a response under 30 words automatically scores at the bottom Conventions band, so writing at least a few full sentences with an opinion and one supporting idea is essential.

#472 • Writing Selected-Response

What self-check questions should you use during the review step for Topic Development?

Answer

Can I point to the exact sentence stating my opinion? Does my opinion stay the same throughout? Does each body paragraph have a specific detail? Do my paragraphs follow a clear order?

#473 · Writing Selected-Response

What self-check questions should you use during the review step for Conventions?

Answer

Is my response well over 30 words? Did I catch obvious spelling slips? Do my sentences make sense when read back? Did I use periods and capital letters correctly?

#474 · Writing Selected-Response

In the sample top-band essay about required volunteer hours, what is the writer's stated opinion?

Answer

The writer agrees that a set number of volunteer hours should be required before graduation everywhere.

#475 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the first reason given in the sample top-band volunteer hours essay?

Answer

Volunteering builds real-world skills, such as communication and responsibility, that are hard to practise in a regular classroom.

#476 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the second reason given in the sample top-band volunteer hours essay?

Answer

Volunteering connects students to people and situations outside their usual routine, building comfort with unfamiliar situations.

#477 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the third reason given in the sample top-band volunteer hours essay?

Answer

Volunteering helps students explore possible careers before making major decisions about their future.

#478 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does the sample top-band essay score well, according to Chapter 8's explanation?

Answer

It states a clear opinion that never wavers, gives one distinct reason per paragraph backed by a specific example, follows a logical order, and stays well over the 30-word minimum with clean spelling and grammar.

#479 · Writing Selected-Response

What was the main problem with the weak sample paragraph about volunteering in Chapter 8?

Answer

It never gave a single specific example, relying on vague filler phrases like 'learn things' and 'good stuff' that could apply to almost any topic.

#480 · Writing Selected-Response

How was the weak volunteering paragraph fixed into a strong version?

Answer

By replacing vague phrases with one specific, concrete example, such as a student sorting donations at a clothing drive and learning independent problem-solving.

#481 · Writing Selected-Response

What single change usually moves a paragraph from the bottom bands to the top bands of the Topic Development rubric?

Answer

Trading vague generalizations for one concrete, specific example that shows exactly what skill is being built and why.

#482 · Writing Selected-Response

What are the final test-day tips given at the end of Chapter 8?

Answer

Pick your side fast and do not look back, plan your reasons in point form, give each body paragraph one reason with one specific example, keep the introduction and conclusion short, and leave time to review.

#483 · Writing Selected-Response

Why should you avoid stopping to fix small spelling mistakes while actively writing your opinion essay?

Answer

Stopping to fix small errors mid-draft slows down your writing time, and those errors can be caught and corrected during the dedicated review step at the end.

#484 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the risk of changing your opinion partway through writing an opinion essay?

Answer

It creates an inconsistent argument that contradicts itself, which directly lowers your score on the Topic Development rubric even if the writing itself is well constructed.

#485 • Writing Selected-Response

Why does Chapter 8 recommend writing your opinion down as a short plan note before starting the introduction?

Answer

It keeps you from drifting into the other side by accident partway through the essay, which is a common problem when writing quickly under time pressure.

#486 • Writing Selected-Response

According to Chapter 8, what happens if you cannot think of a personal experience related to the essay topic?

Answer

You can use observation, noticing something in your school or community related to the topic, or use logical reasoning to walk through a cause-and-effect chain instead.

#487 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is a specific example, like someone who works weekends at a grocery store and learns to manage a schedule, more convincing than a vague claim about part-time jobs teaching responsibility?

Answer

It gives the reader a concrete, picturable scenario showing exactly how the skill is developed, rather than simply asserting the skill exists.

#488 · Writing Selected-Response

How should you allocate more of your writing effort if you are running short on time during the opinion essay?

Answer

Prioritize two strong, well-developed body paragraphs with real detail over three thin, underdeveloped paragraphs.

#489 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the danger of an opinion essay that argues well but never actually states a clear opinion sentence?

Answer

A marker cannot identify the writer's position from a single sentence, which lowers the score on the 'clear opinion' component of the Topic Development rubric.

#490 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does the OSSLT opinion essay reward a simple, repeatable five-paragraph structure?

Answer

A predictable structure keeps the writer organized under time pressure and matches exactly what the Topic Development rubric looks for: a clear opinion and a logical progression of ideas.

#491 · Writing Selected-Response

What should a conclusion avoid doing when restating the opinion?

Answer

It should avoid repeating the exact same wording used in the introduction, instead restating the opinion in different words while briefly summing up the main reasons.

#492 · Writing Selected-Response

Why is 'a few spelling mistakes here and there' not necessarily damaging to a Conventions score?

Answer

As long as a reader can still follow what is being said without confusion, occasional small mistakes will not sink the score, since the rubric checks first-draft writing, not flawless writing.

#493 • Writing Selected-Response

What kind of error does hurt a Conventions score even in first-draft writing?

Answer

A pattern of errors that makes meaning unclear, or sentences so tangled that a reader has to stop and reread to figure out what was meant.

#494 • Writing Selected-Response

According to Chapter 8, why should you practise timing your essay-writing at home before test day?

Answer

So the rhythm of planning, writing, and reviewing feels familiar, and you are not guessing about pacing for the first time during the actual test.

#495 • Writing Selected-Response

What is the relationship between the paragraph-building skills from Chapter 7 and the opinion essay's body paragraphs?

Answer

Each body paragraph of the opinion essay follows the same claim-plus-specific-support pattern taught in Chapter 7, just repeated across two or three separate reasons.

#496 • Writing Selected-Response

Why is committing to a side you can argue well considered more important than personally agreeing with it?

Answer

Because the exam measures your ability to build and support an argument clearly and consistently, not which side of a debate you personally hold in real life.

#497 · Writing Selected-Response

What happens to an opinion essay's score if its body paragraphs are well written but its introduction never clearly states an opinion?

Answer

The Topic Development score suffers, since a marker must be able to identify the writer's opinion clearly from the introduction, regardless of how strong the body paragraphs are.

#498 · Writing Selected-Response

Why does Chapter 6 say the OSSLT is not trying to catch you out on every tiny slip?

Answer

Because the test checks whether your writing communicates clearly, so it focuses on whether convention errors get in the way of that communication rather than punishing every minor mistake.

#499 · Writing Selected-Response

What is the difference between fixing a sentence-level convention error and fixing a paragraph-level organization error?

Answer

A sentence-level fix corrects grammar, punctuation, or spelling within one sentence, while a paragraph-level fix addresses how ideas are arranged, ordered, or connected across multiple sentences.

#500 · Writing Selected-Response

Why should a reviewer of an opinion essay check that the conclusion's restated opinion matches the introduction's stated opinion?

Answer

Because an opinion that shifts or contradicts itself between the introduction and conclusion directly lowers the score on the Topic Development rubric's consistency requirement.